

Philipp Hilbert. *Payment orchestration strategist at the merchant layer.*

Positioning, senior payments PM with a founder track in fintech, a shipped P2P platform inside the girocard ecosystem, and ten years of discovery-to-delivery ownership.

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§ WHY BR-DGE

Payment orchestration sits at the intersection of merchant operations, PSP relationships, and engineering constraints, exactly the space where a PM who can read both a Jira board and a gateway integration spec adds disproportionate value. BR-DGE's position as a pioneer since 2018, with Visa and Worldpay as partners and enterprise travel and retail brands as customers, signals a platform that has earned its seat at the table and is now ready to scale the product organisation around it. The inflection point you describe, deeper partnerships, new markets, growing team, is the moment where the roadmap decisions made today define the next three years of platform capability. *That is exactly the environment where my strengths compound.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo refactors and spec generation
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping for stakeholder show-and-tell
- **GitHub Copilot**, developer-side pairing and review
- **Cursor / VSCode**, agentic coding sessions
- **GPT**, discovery synthesis and edge-case generation
- **Gamma.app**, deck and narrative structuring

- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation
 - **Framer**, design-heavy prototype work
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, Jenkins, CI/CD, Dagster, dbt, Kafka, Jira, Confluence, Shopware, Django, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace for construction staffing, built zero to one.

- Anonymity-until-payment model protecting both sides until commitment is made.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as product surface; LLM agents across the full funnel so one operator runs daily operations.
 - Funnel and conversion tracking in SQL; full discovery, build, and iteration cycle run solo.
 - Demonstrates the vibe-coding and agentic-workflow approach BR-DGE asks for in a live product context.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT BR-DGE

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the onboarding team on a live merchant go-live, read every gateway integration spec and escalation ticket in Jira, and map the merchant workflow from contract sign to first transaction, locating where friction lives before forming any opinion.

WEEK 2

Slice the backlog.

Run a structured triage of the enhancement request queue against the current roadmap sequence, flagging what has a coherent commercial rationale and what is noise, and align that view with the VP of Product before touching priorities.

WEEK 3+

Ship the discovery.

Recruit three to five representative merchant payments or finance personas for interviews, synthesise findings into a problem frame with measurable success criteria, and produce a prototype in Lovable for an internal show-and-tell that lets engineering and commercial react before any story is written.

I COVER LETTER

Dear BR-DGE Team,

Payment orchestration is one of the few product domains where a wrong prioritisation decision does not just slow growth, it directly costs merchants conversion at checkout. That accountability is what drew me to this role. I founded Kvitt Payment Solutions, a mobile P2P payments product that was acquired by Sparkasse and operated inside the girocard ecosystem. That experience gave me a ground-level understanding of PSP relationships, payment edge cases, and the merchant-facing complexity that sits beneath any clean API surface. BR-DGE's platform addresses that complexity at enterprise scale, and the inflection point you describe, scaling the team, deepening partnerships with Visa and Worldpay, entering new markets, is a moment I want to be part of.

Your posting specifically calls out vibe coding as a working practice, not a nice-to-have. I use prototyping tools daily: Lovable for front-end mockups I can put in front of a merchant persona or an internal stakeholder in the same afternoon, Claude Code for in-repo spec generation and edge-case analysis, and n8n for automating the repetitive parts of discovery synthesis. At construct8, my construction-staffing marketplace, I built and iterated the entire product surface solo using this stack, WhatsApp and Telegram as the product layer, LLM agents handling funnel steps, SQL for conversion analysis. The point is not that I can code; it is that I can move from a problem framing to something tangible fast enough that engineering can react to real signal rather than written requirements alone.

At Rohde & Schwarz I led the AI and data platform for the FCAS European defence programme, a 15-person cross-functional team, Scrum in Jira and Confluence, GitOps rollout with ArgoCD that cut deployment time from days to 30 minutes. At EMIL Group I shipped the Claims Center

from concept to production for a B2B SaaS insurance platform and restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three focused teams when it was losing engineers and client trust. Both experiences sharpened the same muscle BR-DGE needs: translating a complex technical platform into a roadmap that both a merchant CFO and a backend engineer can get behind.

Your "nice to have" includes iGaming background. I spent years as a semi-professional poker player and a hand reviewer on PokerStrategy.com, enough domain depth to understand the payment flows, the risk tolerances, and the user behaviours specific to that segment if BR-DGE is pursuing it.

The role you describe, strategic ownership of a core platform domain, close partnership with the VP of Product, and genuine influence over product direction in a high-growth FinTech, matches both where I am and where I want to go. I would welcome a conversation about which domain you have in mind and what the first 90 days look like.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Senior Product Manager with 13 years of product ownership in regulated and technical industries, including a founder track in FinTech and direct experience in payments, insurance, and B2B SaaS platform delivery. I set strategy, lead continuous discovery with merchant and enterprise personas, and drive cross-functional teams through agile delivery from roadmap to production. My AI-native working method, rapid prototyping with Lovable and Claude Code, agentic workflow automation, shortens the loop between a problem framing and something an engineering team can act on.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, product lifecycle management, go-to-market support.

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, epics, backlog refinement, sprint planning, retrospective, story-point estimation, velocity and burndown, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Payments and FinTech: P2P payment platform (founded, shipped, acquired), PSP integration product design, payment flow edge-case handling, girocard ecosystem, merchant workflow mapping.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Agile, Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, ART, PI planning, GitOps rollout and rollback, CI/CD, defect-to-fix cycle time as a product metric.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI; prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Analytics and Data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, MicroStrategy, Matomo.

Technical Environments: Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, Jenkins, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Shopware.

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, budget ownership, ROI reasoning.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI PLATFORM 2024-2025

Led AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme across 15+ engineers and data scientists; cut rollout time from days to 30 minutes via GitOps with ArgoCD; increased pipeline runs 200% by redirecting strategy based on instrumented workflow analysis. Scrum in Jira and Confluence.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

Introduced Dagster and dbt to automate quarterly data imports, saving 75% of update time; migrated bare-metal system to containers; carried full UI relaunch and ETL migration in parallel. Deputy IT Security Officer. Jenkins, CI/CD, PostgreSQL.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE 2023

Cut an undeliverable roadmap to the top 10% of features; user acceptance rose fivefold. Shipped CGM/KIS interface, reducing digital anamnesis from 30 minutes to 5. Jira, iOS/Android.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · B2B SAAS INSURANCE PLATFORM 2022

Restructured 18-person delivery org into three focused teams; attrition dropped from near-total exodus to one departure. Shipped Claims Center from concept to production; cut insurance product launch time from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION · RETAIL & PAYMENTS POS 2021-2022

Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning. Retail payments, POS and forecourt systems.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · SECURE GOVERNMENT DATA 2021

Data structures and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER · B2B PROCUREMENT E-COMMERCE 2019-2020

Migrated legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees; still in production. Backlog refinement, user stories and acceptance criteria in Jira.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY IT 2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · CLINICAL NETWORK 2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION STAFFING FINTECH 2025-2026

Zero-to-one two-sided B2B marketplace; LLM agents across the funnel; SQL-based conversion analysis; anonymity-until-payment model.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Shipped a three-layer enterprise security product installing in under two minutes; later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO · NANOTECHNOLOGY 2018-2021

Lab to investor rounds; financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH PAYMENTS
2013-2018

Founded mobile P2P payments platform; acquired by Sparkasse, operated inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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